

IVAN LARININ

Technical Artist / Real-Time FX & Procedural TD

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

VES Award-winning Technical Director & FX Artist with extensive experience in procedural systems, physical simulations, and pipeline tooling. Combining a strong artistic eye with deep expertise in Houdini (VEX/Python), Unity (C#, Compute Shaders, HLSL), and Unreal Engine (Houdini Engine HDAs). Focused on real-time graphics, GPU instancing, Vertex Animation Textures (VAT), and optimized environment set dressing tools for real-time interactive applications.

TECHNICAL TOOLKIT

Game Engines & Real-Time: Unity Engine, Unreal Engine, Houdini Engine (HDA Integration), HLSL / Compute Shaders, GPU Instancing, VAT
Procedural & FX Solvers: Houdini (VEX, Python, HDAs), FLIP Water Dynamics, Vellum, Pyro, Bullet RBD, Procedural City & Terrain HDAs
Programming & Scripting: C++, C#, Python, VEX, HLSL, OpenCL, Git.

GAMEDEV & PROCEDURAL PROJECTS SHOWCASE

Laminaria - GPU Instanced Procedural Tool

[Unity, Houdini FX, VAT]

- Built a Unity GPU-instanced procedural tool for scattering animated Laminaria prefabs.
- Integrated Vertex Animation Textures (VAT) authored in Houdini FX for high-fidelity real-time deformation.
- Automated placement logic enabling efficient environment set dressing with optimized GPU-driven animation data.

Ocean Shader & Real-Time Water Simulation

[Compute Shader, HLSL, Unity]

- Moved Gerstner wave simulation to GPU Compute Shaders to decouple simulation cost from surface geometry.
- Implemented distance-based Hull/Domain tessellation shaders and camera near-plane split-view rendering.
- Generated global displacement and normal maps consumed by buoyancy physics and post-processing depth fog.

Procedural Building & City Generator

[Unreal Engine, Houdini Engine]

- Created interactive Houdini Engine HDAs for Unreal Engine to procedurally generate building geometry.
- Automated layout distributions and modular architectural assets directly inside the game viewport.

Houdini Engine Environment Utilities

[Unity, Houdini Engine]

- Developed procedural rock arch generation and terrain rock scattering HDAs integrated into Unity Terrain.

SandPile Cellular Automata

[C++, OpenCL]

- Programmed a high-performance C++ implementation of the Abelian Sandpile Model utilizing OpenCL acceleration.

VFX & STUDIO EXPERIENCE

Senior FX Artist / FX Technical Director

Stockholm / London / Remote

Top-Tier Visual Effects Studios (DNEG, Sony Pictures Imageworks, Pixomondo)

- Owned complex FX sequences from concept to final output, managing references, lookdev, and simulation networks.
- Built high-performance procedural networks and master presets in Houdini to empower cross-department utility.
- Key Feature Credits: Dune (VES Award-winning team), Spider-Man: No Way Home, M3GAN, The Boys, Uncharted.

HONORS & PUBLICATIONS

Visual Effects Society (VES) Award Winner

- Outstanding Effects Simulations in a Photoreal Feature (Dune)

Technical Writer & Contributor

- 80 Level & Industry Publications (Procedural setups & Houdini dynamics)